Shipping the Chama redesign

Wazo Moja Self-Help Group · the steps for the day the group pays · prepared 29 October 2026

Where things stand

Item	State
The upgrade	Everything is on the local branch `redesign`, 20 commits ahead of `main`. Tip: `6142583`.
`main`	Untouched since the work began, at `d0a8d21`. It is one commit ahead of the remote (the meeting-report test pin), and that commit goes out with the push.
Published?	Nothing. `redesign` has never been pushed, and a local `pre-push` hook refuses to push it.
New settings or data work	None. No environment variables, no migration, no new dependencies.
Tests	Backend 378, frontend 105, and all 21 integration suites (real database) pass.

The steps

1 Make sure nothing changed while you waited

```
git checkout redesign
git merge main
```

This does nothing if `main` has not moved. If you fixed something on `main` in the meantime, any conflict shows up here, not in production. Then run `npm test` in `backend/` and in `frontend/`.

2 Merge, with a clean way back

```
git checkout main
git tag before-redesign-ship d0a8d21
git merge --no-ff redesign
```

The tag marks the old `main`. `--no-ff` makes the whole upgrade one merge commit, which is what makes a clean undo possible (see Rolling back).

3 Push, and deploy the backend before the frontend

```
git push origin main
```

1. Redeploy the **backend** on its own host, as you normally do.
2. Then the **frontend** builds on Netlify from `main`.

Order matters because the new frontend calls two new backend features, the office Constitution page and Print register. An old frontend runs fine on the new backend, but a new frontend on the old backend would show a broken Constitution page and a Print register that downloads a spreadsheet.

> You do **not** need to delete `.git/hooks/pre-push` to push `main`. The hook only blocks pushing the `redesign` branch itself. (A line in `REDESIGN.md` says otherwise; ignore it.)

4 Check it on the live site

- ☐ Open the site with the browser console open. Look for Content-Security-Policy complaints (a new, small policy is sent by Netlify).
- ☐ Sign in. The menu should be green, the dashboard should show the green card and the weekly ring.
- ☐ Open **Constitution** and confirm the group's real text is there. It reads from the database, like the members' page. A blank page means the text was never loaded into the database (`npm run seed:constitution`).
- ☐ Print a member statement, the **Print register** PDF and the meeting report. Each should have the logo and the group name on top.
- ☐ If mail is set up on the host, send yourself a password-reset email to see the green band.
- ☐ Open the members' page signed out, and look up a member with an ID.

Expected and harmless: phones that had the app open will briefly show the "update available" banner. A link pasted into WhatsApp may keep showing the old preview card for a while.

5 Tell the group

Hand over the committee section of `WHAT-WE-ADDED.md` and the rebuilt `USER_INTERACTION_GUIDE.pdf`. Both describe the new menu entry, Print register and the Constitution page.

Rolling back

If something is wrong after the deploy, undo the merge with a new commit. This keeps history and needs no force-push:

```
git checkout main
git log --merges -1            # note the merge commit's id
git revert -m 1 <that id>
git push origin main
```

Redeploy as in step 3. The tag `before-redesign-ship` still marks exactly what the live site was before.

> **Avoid** `git reset --hard` followed by a force-push to roll back. It rewrites the published history for everyone and is hard to undo. Use the revert above.

What the release contains

Area	What changed
Look	Green menu (side panel and phone bars) with a gold marker on the current page; new sign-in screen with the group's logo; green dashboard card with a weekly progress ring; grouped Settings; members' page header in the brand green; page skeletons while data loads.
Paper	One letterhead on every PDF (logo, name, gold rule, faint watermark, green headings). Names with Gikuyu letters no longer print with gaps. A line on the member statement that overprinted the next is fixed.
Emails	All six messages (reminders, fines, password reset, statements) arrive in a green band with the group's name. Text only, so mail apps cannot block it.
New for the office	**Print register** (Members): a landscape PDF without ID numbers. **Constitution** on the menu for every office role, with approve/reject counts per chapter and a print that gives the whole text.
Reliability	A phone open during a deploy loads the new version once. A single failing screen no longer blanks the app.
Hosting and icons	A small Content-Security-Policy; the tab icon, home-screen icons and the WhatsApp link card are the group's logo.
Accessibility	Visible keyboard focus on the menu; small white text raised to 4.5:1 contrast; one bottom tab lit at a time.
Tests and docs	New integration tests for the office Constitution route and the register PDF; user guide, committee notes and `REDESIGN.md` updated.

Left out on purpose

- Anything tied to the other group's operations: the meeting roll, joining fees, expense approvals, benefits and the "tea" naming.
- The other system's demo mode (a portfolio feature, not an upgrade for the group).
- A script policy in the Content-Security-Policy. It needs testing against every screen first; add it in report-only form to begin with.
- The passbook still lists every fund, including those at Ksh 0. The existing code says that is deliberate.

Known gaps

- The single-member fines PDF was not rendered and looked at (same letterhead, its tests pass).
- The group's muted gold on the grey page background is 4.45:1 contrast, marginally under 4.5. It is the group's own colour and was already there.
- The Content-Security-Policy only takes effect on Netlify, so it could not be tried locally. Step 4 covers it.

More detail: `REDESIGN.md` in the repository root. Artwork scripts: `frontend/scripts/make-icons.py`, `make-favicons.py`, `make-og-image.py`.